

EAM310 · EAM DIAGNOSIS I · VUIM · SUMMER 2026

Workbook

Complete Reference — 28 Qualities, 127 Combinations, Positions

Prof. Daniel Schrier, D.O.M., L.Ac.

Week 3 · Pulse Diagnosis · Summer 2026

Jonathan Centeno · D.AcHM Candidate · VUIM 2026–2030

1 Pulse Positions — 寸關尺

Position	Left	Right	Burner
寸 Cùn (1st, Front)	Hand Taiyang / SI · Hand Shaoyin / HT	Hand Yangming / LI · Hand Taiyin / LU	Upper Burner
關 Guān (2nd, Middle)	Foot Shaoyang / GB · Foot Jueyin / LR	Foot Yangming / ST · Foot Taiyin / SP	Middle Burner
尺 Chǐ (3rd, Rear)	Foot Taiyang / BL · Foot Shaoyin / KD	Hand Shaoyang / TB · Hand Jueyin / PC	Lower Burner

Note on Schools

Some modern shorthand simplifies the two Chǐ positions to "Kidney-Yin / Kidney-Yang." Schrier teaches the full Nan Jing organ pairings above — use those.

2 The Five Finger Movements

#	Movement	Checks for
1	Lifting	Superficial level — light touch
2	Pressing	Deep level — firm touch to the bone
3	Searching	Rate
4	Pushing	Shape
5	Rolling	Length

3 Components of a Normal Pulse — the 8 Parameters

Component	Normal state
Width	Diameter of the vessel, dependent on Qi and Blood. Should be moderate — neither too thin nor too wide.
Depth	Where the pulse is felt strongest. Normal is the middle depth — Qi and Blood flow freely interior ↔ exterior.
Rate	4–5 beats per respiratory cycle, or 60–90bpm. Rate reflects the state of the Yang.
Rhythm	Pattern of beats. Normal is regular — closely tied to Heart Qi, which commands Blood through the vessels.
Strength	Beating force beneath the finger. Moderate — gentle and soft, neither forceful nor forceless.
Length	Length across the three positions. Felt at all positions, neither too long nor short. Qi governs length.
Tension	Neither too taut nor too slack. Predominantly a manifestation of the condition of Qi and Blood.
Shape	Wave or contour — rising and falling as blood flows. Ascending and descending should be about equal.

4 胃神根 — The Three Qualities

Character	Quality	Meaning
胃 Wèi	Stomach-Qi	Flowing, gentle, harmonious movement
神 Shén	Spirit	Strong, rhythmical — vitality present in the beat
根 Gēn	Root	Depth felt at Chǐ — Kidney Qi intact under firm pressure

5 Seasonal Pulses

Season	Pulse	Dates	Why
Spring	Wiry 弦	Feb 4 – May 4	Yang Qi wants to rise; Cold-Yin nature still obstructs release — shouldn't be too wiry
Summer	Flooding 洪	May 5 – Aug 6	Yang Qi uninhibited, spreading freely, at its peak
Autumn	Hair-like / Floating 毛	Aug 7 – Nov 6	Yang Qi desiring to be restrained and collected — "dainty, like elm pods falling"
Winter	Stone / Deep 石	Nov 7 – Feb 3	Yang Qi gathered and stored; sinks like a stone

6 The 28 Pulse Qualities — Full Reference

Quality	Sensation & Classical Image	Indications
1. Floating 浮 Fú	Felt distinctly at the superficial depth; force decreases slightly deeper but never feels empty. <i>Classical:</i> Wood floating on the surface of water; a subtle breeze across a bird's back; scallion leaves rolled lightly between the fingers.	Invasion of external Wind. Yin Deficiency (interior condition presenting superficially).
2. Deep / Submerged 沉 Chén	Located deep next to the bone; barely felt with light or moderate pressure; only felt pressing to bone and tendons. <i>Classical:</i> A stone thrown into a well, sinking to the bottom.	Pathogenic factor in the Interior (Deep-Full). Yang Deficiency (Deep-Weak).
3. Slow 遲 Chí	Fewer than three beats per breath, about 40–60bpm, regular rhythm.	Cold pattern. Empty-Cold (Slow+Weak). Full-Cold (Slow+Full).
4. Rapid 數 Shuò	Over five beats per breath, 90–140bpm, regular rhythm.	Heat pattern. Full-Heat (Rapid+Full). Empty-Heat (Rapid+Floating-Empty).
5. Empty / Deficient 虛 Xū	Wide but without strength; forceless at all three positions under light or heavy pressure; a sense of emptiness. <i>Classical:</i> A water balloon — big on the outside, nothing solid when you press in.	Qi Deficiency.
6. Full / Excessive 實 Shí	Felt at all three positions and all three depths; long, wide, and forceful.	Full pattern. Full-Heat (Full+Rapid). Full-Cold (Full+Slow).
7. Slippery 滑 Huá	Feels quick though not rapid; slippery and smooth; rounded inside the vessel, as if oily. <i>Classical:</i> A pearl rolling on a plate; a raindrop gliding off a leaf.	Phlegm. Dampness. Retention of food. Pregnancy.
8. Choppy 澀 Sè	Seems slow and is not smooth; vessel is thin; rhythm irregular in force and fullness; feels rough, jagged. <i>Classical:</i> Scraping bamboo with a small knife.	Blood Deficiency. Exhaustion of Body Fluids.
9. Long 長 Cháng	Smooth and straight; felt extending distally and proximally beyond the usual positions.	Heat patterns.
10. Short 短 Duǎn	Cannot be felt in all three positions; absent at the distal and/or proximal position.	Severe Qi Deficiency. Stomach-Qi Deficiency.
11. Overflowing / Flooding 洪 Hóng	Wide and forceful, though it fades gently; vessel wide and thick. <i>Classical:</i> Ocean waves that come strongly but leave calmly.	Full-Heat. Empty-Heat (Overflowing-Empty).

Quality	Sensation & Classical Image	Indications
12. Fine / Thin 細 <i>Xī</i>	Very thin, like a fine thread, but distinct and clear without interruption of rhythm under pressure. <i>Classical:</i> Angel-hair pasta rather than a thick udon noodle.	Blood Deficiency. Dampness with severe Qi Deficiency.
13. Minute / Faint 微 <i>Wēi</i>	Extremely thin and forceless; seems felt, then not felt; pressing deeply the vessel becomes vague. <i>Classical:</i> Now you see it, now you don't.	Severe deficiency of Qi and Blood.
14. Tight 緊 <i>Jǐn</i>	Rises and falls with strength, vibrating left and right; feels twisted like a thick rope. <i>Classical:</i> Fingers on a highly stretched twisted cord, snapping back and forth.	Cold — Exterior (Tight-Floating), Interior Full-Cold (Tight-Full-Deep), Interior Empty-Cold (Tight-Weak-Deep). Pain.
15. Wiry 弦 <i>Xián</i>	Taut, long, and forceful whether pressed or not; maintains a straight line beneath the fingers. <i>Classical:</i> A spring stretched on a musical instrument; a guitar string about to snap.	Liver disharmony. Pain. Phlegm.
16. Slowed-Down / Moderate 緩 <i>Huǎn</i>	Beats four times per breath — faster than the Slow pulse.	Generally a HEALTHY pulse — the one qualitatively normal entry on this list.
17. Hollow 芤 <i>Kōu</i>	Wide and soft when touched lightly, hollow when seeking; edges clearly felt under pressure but the center is obscure. <i>Classical:</i> A scallion stalk — has an edge but is hollow inside.	Hemorrhage. Forthcoming hemorrhage (Hollow+Rapid). Yin Deficiency.
18. Leather 革 <i>Gé</i>	Large, thick, and wide; rapid and forceful when lightly touched, but hollow when pressed deeply. <i>Classical:</i> The surface of a drum — thick on top, hollow beneath.	Severe Kidney-Essence Deficiency. Severe Kidney-Yin Deficiency.
19. Firm / Confined 牢 <i>Láo</i>	Deep, taut, long, wide, and forceful; deeply located, cannot be felt with light or moderate pressure.	Blood Stasis. Interior Cold (Firm+Slow). Pain.
20. Soggy 濡 <i>Rú</i>	Superficial, thin, and forceless; grows weaker and weaker the more it is pressed. <i>Classical:</i> A strand of cotton floating on water; a bubble that bursts under light pressure.	Dampness with Qi Deficiency. Yin Deficiency. Essence Deficiency.
21. Weak / Frail 弱 <i>Ruò</i>	Forceless, deep, and thin; only felt at the deep level by pressing; lost entirely with more pressure.	Yang Deficiency. Blood Deficiency.
22. Scattered 散 <i>Sàn</i>	Wide, superficial, forceless, and slack when touched lightly; indistinct; disappears under pressure, rate hard to count. <i>Classical:</i> Flower blossoms lightly scattering to the ground.	Severe Qi and Blood Deficiency. Severe Kidney-Qi Deficiency. A serious condition.

Quality	Sensation & Classical Image	Indications
23. Hidden 伏 Fú	Cannot be felt touching, seeking, or pressing — only felt pressing very heavily to the bone. <i>Classical:</i> Pulsation seeming to come from beneath the bone and tendons.	Severe Yang Deficiency.
24. Moving 動 Dòng	Rapid and slippery; forceful specifically at the middle portion. <i>Classical:</i> A bean bouncing in the vessel — well-defined peaks, no head or tail.	Shock, anxiety, fright. Pain.
25. Hasty 促 Cù	Beats rapidly with irregular, random stops. <i>Classical:</i> Agitated and urgent, like a man running and suddenly falling down.	Severe Heat. Deficiency of Heart-Qi. Heart-Fire.
26. Knotted 結 Jié	Slow with irregularly missed beats; the pulse resumes immediately after the missed beat.	Cold with Heart-Yang Deficiency.
27. Intermittent 代 Dài	Pauses at REGULAR intervals; resumes after the pause.	Serious problem in the internal organs. Heart problem (Western medical sense).
28. Hurried / Racing 疾 Jí	Rapid, beating more than seven times per breath (140–180bpm) — an extreme version of Rapid; rhythm stays regular.	Fire exhausting Yin.

7 Complete Combinations Reference

Quality	Full combination list
Floating (Fú)	· Floating-Weak: External-Empty — weak Wei Qi failing to react properly to external pathogenic invasion · Floating-Empty: Summer-Heat invasion (floats MORE) vs. Yin Deficiency (floats less) — degree is the differentiator · Floating-Slippery: invasion of Wind-Damp, or Wind complicated by Phlegm
Deep / Submerged (Chén)	· Deep-Weak: Yang Deficiency · Deep-Wiry: Blood Stasis, or a Chong Mai issue · Deep-Wiry-Slow: Blood stasis due to Cold, or Cold stagnating in the Liver channel · Deep-Slow: interior Cold · Deep-Rapid: interior Heat · Deep-Soggy-Slow: Dampness in the Interior

Quality	Full combination list
Slow (Chí)	· Slow-Floating: exterior Wind-Cold with prevalence of Wind · Slow-Deep: interior Cold · Slow-Slippery: Cold-Phlegm or Damp-Cold · Slow-Choppy: Blood Deficiency and interior Cold · Slow-Weak: Empty-Cold with Yang Deficiency · Slow-Full: internal Cold, often chronic painful conditions · Slow-Wiry: stagnation of Cold in the Liver channel
Rapid (Shuò)	· Rapid-Full: Full-Heat from Excess of Yang · Rapid-Empty: Empty-Heat from Deficiency of Yin · Rapid-Fine / Rapid-Floating: External Wind-Heat · Rapid-Deep: interior Heat · Rapid-Overflowing: Full-Heat · Rapid-Wiry: Liver-Fire · Rapid-Slippery: Phlegm-Heat
Full / Excessive (Shí)	· Full-Rapid: Full-Heat · Full-Slow: Full-Cold · Full-Tight: Full-Cold · Full-Slippery: Phlegm · Full-Long: Heat · Full-Wiry: Full Liver pattern
Slippery (Huá)	· Slippery-Floating: Wind-Phlegm · Slippery-Rapid: Damp-Heat or Phlegm-Heat · Slippery-Slow: Damp-Cold or Cold-Phlegm · Slippery-Big: Phlegm-Heat with predominance of Heat · Slippery-Short: Dampness or Phlegm with Qi Deficiency · Slippery-Weak: Dampness or Phlegm with Qi Deficiency
Choppy (Sè)	· Choppy-Weak: depletion of both Qi and Blood · Choppy-Minute: extreme Blood Deficiency · Choppy-Soggy: Qi and Blood Deficiency with some Dampness · Choppy-Floating: invasion of external Wind · Choppy-Deep: longstanding Blood Deficiency · Choppy-Full: Blood Stasis (potentially) · Choppy-Knotted: Blood Stasis from Yang Deficiency and internal Cold · Choppy-Fine: Deficiency of Body Fluids
Long (Cháng)	· Long-Rapid: internal Heat · Long-Floating: external Wind-Heat · Long-Deep: internal Heat · Long-Wiry: Liver disharmony (usually excess) · Long-Slippery: Phlegm-Heat · Long-Overflowing: excess of Yang and Heat
Short (Duǎn)	· Short-Floating: Lung-Qi Deficiency · Short-Choppy: Heart-Qi Deficiency · Short-Rapid: severe Heart-Blood Deficiency with Empty-Heat · Short-Slow: Yang Deficiency with internal Cold

Quality	Full combination list
Overflowing / Flooding (Hóng)	· Overflowing-Floating: Wind-Heat with intense Heat — can progress quickly to the Qi level · Overflowing-Deep: internal Heat · Overflowing-Slippery: Phlegm-Heat with prevalence of Heat · Overflowing-Soft: Yin Deficiency with exhaustion of Body Fluids and Empty-Heat · Overflowing-Tight: Painful Obstruction (Bi) Syndrome
Fine / Thin (Xì)	· Fine-Rapid: Yin Deficiency with Empty-Heat · Fine-Wiry: Liver-Qi Stagnation · Fine-Tight: Empty-Cold with underlying Blood Deficiency · Fine-Choppy: severe Blood or Essence Deficiency · Fine-Weak: severe Blood Deficiency
Minute / Faint (Wēi)	· Minute-Rapid: Yin Deficiency with Empty-Heat · Minute-Slow: severe Qi & Blood Deficiency with internal Cold · Minute-Choppy: exhaustion of Blood · Minute-Soggy: Qi & Blood Deficiency with Dampness · Minute-Wiry: Liver-Yang rising with underlying Blood Deficiency
Tight (Jǐn)	· Tight-Floating: Wind-Cold invasion, prevalence of Cold · Tight-Deep: internal Full-Cold · Tight-Choppy: Cold Bi Syndrome · Tight-Slippery: Cold-Phlegm · Tight-Firm: Blood Stasis from Cold
Wiry (Xián)	· Wiry-Rapid: Liver-Fire · Wiry-Slow: stagnation of Cold in the Liver channel · Wiry-Long: Liver-Qi Stagnation or Liver-Blood Stasis · Wiry-Tight: Blood Stasis · Wiry-Big: Liver-Fire or Liver-Yang rising · Wiry-Overflowing: Liver-Fire
Slowed-Down / Moderate (Huǎn)	· Slowed-Down-Soggy: Dampness with Spleen-Qi Deficiency · Slowed-Down-Slippery: Cold-Dampness · Slowed-Down-Fine: Qi and Blood Deficiency · Slowed-Down-Floating: weakness of the Wei Qi · Slowed-Down-Deep: weakness of the Ying Qi · Slowed-Down-Choppy: Blood Deficiency
Hollow (Kōu)	· Hollow-Rapid: Yin Deficiency with Empty-Heat, or impending hemorrhage · Hollow-Empty-Soggy: loss of Essence or depletion of Blood · Hollow-Knotted: Yang Deficiency or Blood Stasis
Leather (Gé)	· Leather-Rapid: severe Deficiency of Yin with Empty-Heat · Leather-Slow: severe Blood Deficiency with Blood Stasis · Leather-Choppy: severe Blood Deficiency
Firm / Confined (Láo)	· Firm-Tight: internal Cold · Firm-Slow: internal Cold and Blood Stasis · Firm-Choppy: Blood Stasis

Quality	Full combination list
Soggy (Rú)	· Soggy-Fine: severe Spleen-Qi Deficiency · Soggy-Choppy: exhaustion of Blood · Soggy-Floating: Deficiency of Wei Qi with Dampness · Soggy-Wiry: Dampness with Liver-Qi Stagnation · Soggy-Rapid: Damp-Heat
Weak / Frail (Ruò)	· Weak-Choppy: Blood Deficiency · Weak-Fine: severe Blood Deficiency · Weak-Slow: Yang Deficiency · Weak-Soggy: Yang Deficiency with some Dampness
Scattered (Sàn)	· Scattered-Slow: severe Qi and Yang Deficiency · Scattered-Rapid: severe Blood Deficiency with Empty-Heat · Scattered-Floating: severe Deficiency of Yuan Qi with floating of Yang, or with Yin Fire
Hidden (Fú)	· Hidden-Full: Qi and Blood stagnation; retention of food; internal Cold; internal Heat · Hidden-Empty: severe Yang Deficiency with internal Cold · Hidden-Rapid: interior Heat · Hidden-Slow: interior Cold
Moving (Dòng)	· Moving-Rapid: Heat · Moving-Slippery: Deficiency of Qi and Phlegm · Moving-Empty: severe depletion of Blood · Moving-Weak: Shock
Hasty (Cù)	· Hasty-Overflowing: Heat in the Stomach · Hasty-Slippery: retention of Phlegm-Heat · Hasty-Wiry: Liver-Fire and Heart-Fire · Hasty-Slippery-Wiry: Heart-Fire, Liver-Fire, and Phlegm-Heat · Hasty-Fine without strength: collapse of Heart-Qi
Knotted (Jié)	· Knotted-Choppy: Blood Stasis · Knotted-Slippery: retention of Phlegm · Knotted-Deep: accumulation in the Interior · Knotted-Wiry: disease of the arteries, or hypertension
Hurried / Racing (Jí)	· Hurried-Floating: severe Empty-Heat from Yin Deficiency · Hurried-Floating-Empty: severe Yin Deficiency · Hurried-Slippery: Empty-Heat from Yin Deficiency with Phlegm · Hurried-Overflowing: Empty-Heat arising from Yin Deficiency

8 Pulse Quality Comparison — Schrier's Chart

Dimension	Pole 1	Pole 2
Speed / Rate	Rapid/Fast: Rapid, Moving, Hurried/Racing, Slippery	Slow: Slow, Choppy, Moderate/Slowed-Down
Form — Shape	Wiry, Slippery, Choppy, Tight	—

Dimension	Pole 1	Pole 2
Form — Size/Width	Big/Large, Minute/Faint, Fine/Thin, Overflowing/Flooding/Surging, Weak/Frail	—
Form — Length	Short	Long
Strength / Arrival	Excess: Overflowing/Flooding/Surging, Tight/ Tense, Full/Excess	Deficiency: Deficiency/Empty, Minute, Weak/ Frail
Rhythm	Knotted, Hasty, Intermittent	—
Depth	Superficial/Floating: Floating, Soggy, Leather/ Drumskin, Scattered, Hollow/Scallion	Deep: Deep/Submerged, Firm/Confined, Hidden